

ACTIVITY SHEET

21st Century Literature from the Philippines and the World

Competency Code: EN12Lit-IIij-31.1, EN12Lit-IIij-31.2, EN12Lit-IIij-31.3

Learning Objectives:

- Understanding: Interpret the short story through a short film adaptation
- Analyzing: Outline the short story “Powder” by Tobias Wolff
- Evaluating: Critique the adaptation using self- and peer- assessment based on a rationalized criteria
- Creating: Plan and produce an adaptation of a short story using multimedia and ICT skills
- Initiate responsibility and cooperation in working on a creative adaptation
- Observe oneness and concern for others

ACTIVITY 1. Guess this Flick! (Guessing Game)

You are going to guess the title of the movie trailers to be shown on the screen. Please pay attention to the screen and observe silence.

Guide Questions. Discuss answers with learners.

1. What is common regarding these movies/films?
2. Why do you think novels make great film adaptations?
3. Why are film adaptations becoming more and more popular these days?
4. When reading a particular novel or short story, do you imagine yourself watching it as a film or a TV series?

ACTIVITY 2. Unlocking Unfamiliar Words.

These words are found in the story to be tackled later. Find their meaning through this activity. Match the **bold-lettered words** as used in a sentence to their meanings in box. Write the letter of your answer on the blanks before the numbers corresponding to each of the sentences.

- _____ 1. The **squalls** hit us with their flying sands.
- _____ 2. **Troopers** usually bring their weapons.
- _____ 3. There are so many **barricades** in the road delaying our trip.
- _____ 4. His grandpa is **humming** an old tune.
- _____ 5. The pig **grunted** and shuffled back to the sty.
- _____ 6. The **rasp** of engines in the nearby factory is very irritating.
- _____ 7. Cats usually **purr** when expressing contentment.
- _____ 8. It is not slavery because there is no **coercion**.
- _____ 9. I respect his **subtlety** in leaving the conference room.
- _____ 10. The old dog has **sparse** fur.

- a. thinly scattered
- b. sudden and violent gust of wind
- c. private soldiers
- d. barrier
- e. low, steady sound
- f. not obvious
- g. forcing someone to do something
- h. low vibratory sound
- i. low, short and harsh sound
- j. a harsh grating sound

ACTIVITY 3. Reading the Story

You will be tasked to read the story “Powder” by Tobias Wolff. Your class will be grouped by your teacher into four (4). Assign a leader and have them divide the story into four parts. Individually, the members will read and study their assigned story parts. You may read the story and discuss your insights with your group mates.

About the Author:

Tobias Wolff or Tobias Jonathan Ansell Wolff was born on June 19, 1945 at Birmingham, Alabama. His notable works are “Old School” and “The Barracks Thief”. He received numerous awards in literature including the National Medal of Arts (2015).

Here are guide questions before reading:

1. What do you think the story will be about based on the title?
2. Does the topic remind you of anything? An experience?

Here are the guide questions while reading:

1. Who are the compelling characters?
2. As you are reading, what pictures come to your mind?
3. Is there anything you are wondering about while reading the short story?

Answer them on your notebook.

Read the story:

Powder by Tobias Wolff

Just before Christmas my father took me skiing at Mount Baker. He’d had to fight for the privilege of my company, because my mother was still angry with him for sneaking me into a nightclub during his last visit, to see Thelonious Monk.

He wouldn’t give up. He promised, hand on heart, to take good care of me and have me home for dinner on Christmas Eve, and she relented. But as we were checking out of the lodge that morning it began to snow, and in this snow he observed some rare quality that made it necessary for us to get in one last run. We got in several last runs. He was indifferent to my fretting. Snow whirled around us in bitter, blinding squalls, hissing like sand, and still we skied. As the lift bore us to the peak yet again, my father looked at his watch and said, “Criminy. This’ll have to be a fast one.”

By now I couldn’t see the trail. There was no point in trying. I stuck close behind him and did what he did and somehow made it to the bottom without sailing off a cliff. We returned our skis and my father put chains on the Austin-Healey while I swayed from foot to foot, clapping my mittens and wishing I was home. I could see everything. The green tablecloth, the plates with the holly pattern, the red candles waiting to be lit.

We passed a diner on our way out. “You want some soup?” my father asked. I shook my head. “Buck up,” he said. “I’ll get you there. Right, doctor?”

I was supposed to say, “Right, doctor,” but I didn’t say anything.

A state trooper waved us down outside the resort, where a pair of sawhorses blocked the road. He came up to our car and bent down to my father’s window, his face bleached

by the cold, snowflakes clinging to his eyebrows and to the fur trim of his jacket and cap.

"Don't tell me," my father said.

The trooper told him. The road was closed. It might get cleared, it might not. Storm took everyone by surprise. Hard to get people moving. Christmas Eve. What can you do.

My father said, "Look. We're talking about five, six inches. I've taken this car through worse than that."

The trooper straightened up. His face was out of sight but I could hear him. "The road is closed."

My father sat with both hands on the wheel, rubbing the wood with his thumbs. He looked at the barricade for a long time. He seemed to be trying to master the idea of it. Then he thanked the trooper and with a weird, old-maidy show of caution turned the car around. "Your mother will never forgive me for this," he said.

"We should've left this morning," I said. "Doctor."

He didn't speak to me again until we were in a booth at the diner, waiting for our burgers. "She won't forgive me," he said. "Do you understand? Never."

"I guess," I said, though no guesswork was required. She wouldn't forgive him.

"I can't let that happen." He bent toward me. "I'll tell you what I want. I want us all to be together again. Is that what you want?"

"Yes, sir."

He bumped my chin with his knuckles. "That's all I needed to hear."

When we finished eating he went to the pay phone in the back of the diner, then joined me in the booth again. I figured he'd called my mother, but he didn't give a report. He sipped at his coffee and stared out the window at the empty road. "Come on, come on," he said, though not to me. A little while later he said it again. When the trooper's car went past, lights flashing, he got up and dropped some money on the check. "Okay. Vámonos."

The wind had died. The snow was falling straight down, less of it now and lighter. We drove away from the resort, right up to the barricade. "Move it," my father told me. When I looked at him, he said, "What are you waiting for?" I got out and dragged one of the sawhorses aside, then put it back after he drove through. He pushed the door open for me. "Now you're an accomplice," he said. "We go down together." He put the car into gear and gave me a look. "Joke, son."

Down the first long stretch I watched the road behind us, to see if the trooper was on our tail. The barricade vanished. Then there was nothing but snow: snow on the road, snow kicking up from the chains, snow on the trees, snow in the sky, and our trail in the snow. Then I faced forward and had a shock. There were no tracks ahead of us. My father was breaking virgin snow between tall treelines. He was humming "Stars Fell on Alabama." I felt snow brush along the floorboards under my feet. To keep my hands from shaking I clamped them between my knees.

My father grunted thoughtfully and said, "Don't ever try this yourself."

"I won't."

"That's what you say now, but someday you'll get your license and then you'll think you can do anything. Only you won't be able to do this. You need, I don't know—a certain instinct."

"Maybe I have it."

"You don't. You have your strong points, sure, just not this. I only mention it because I don't want you to get the idea this is something anybody can do. I'm a great driver. That's not a virtue, okay? It's just a fact, and one you should be aware of. Of course you have to give the old heap some credit too. There aren't many cars I'd try this with. Listen!"

I did listen. I heard the slap of the chains, the stiff, jerky rasp of the wipers, the purr

of the engine. It really did purr. The old heap was almost new. My father couldn't afford it, and kept promising to sell it, but here it was.

I said, "Where do you think that policeman went to?"

"Are you warm enough?" He reached over and cranked up the blower. Then he turned off the wipers. We didn't need them. The clouds had brightened. A few sparse, feathery flakes drifted into our slipstream and were swept away. We left the trees and entered a broad eld of snow that ran level for a while and then tilted sharply downward. Orange stakes had been planted at intervals in two parallel lines and my father steered a course between them, though they were far enough apart to leave considerable doubt in my mind as to exactly where the road lay. He was humming again, doing little scat riffs around the melody.

"Okay, then. What are my strong points?"

"Don't get me started," he said. "It'd take all day."

"Oh, right. Name one."

"Easy. You always think ahead."

True. I always thought ahead. I was a boy who kept his clothes on numbered hangers to ensure proper rotation. I bothered my teachers for homework assignments far ahead of their due dates so I could draw up schedules. I thought ahead, and that was why I knew there would be other troopers waiting for us at the end of our ride, if we even got there. What I didn't know was that my father would wheedle and plead his way past them—he didn't sing "O Tannenbaum," but just about—and get me home for dinner, buying a little more time before my mother decided to make the split final. I knew we'd get caught; I was resigned to it. And maybe for this reason I stopped moping and began to enjoy myself.

Why not? This was one for the books. Like being in a speedboat, only better. You can't go downhill in a boat. And it was all ours. And it kept coming, the laden trees, the unbroken surface of snow, the sudden white vistas. Here and there I saw hints of the road, ditches, fences, stakes, though not so many that I could have found my own way. But then I didn't have to. My father was driving. My father in his forty-eighth year, rumped, kind, bankrupt of honor, flushed with certainty. He was a great driver. All persuasion, no coercion. Such subtlety at the wheel, such tactful pedal work. I actually trusted him. And the best was yet to come—switchbacks and hairpins impossible to describe. Except maybe to say this: if you haven't driven fresh powder, you haven't driven.

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ACTIVITY 4. Reading Comprehension

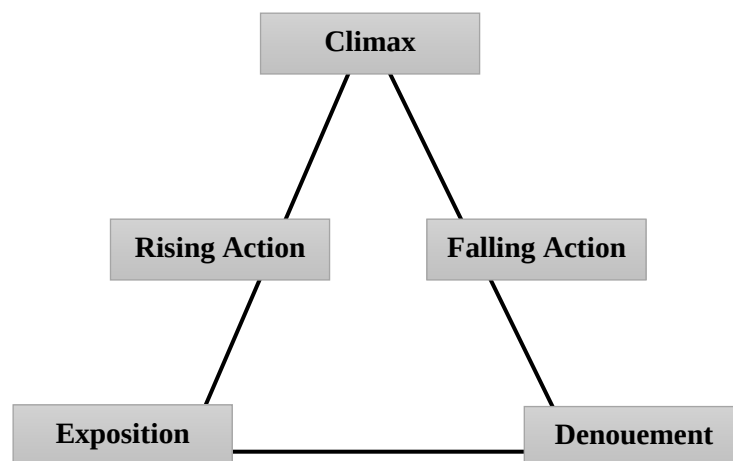
Read and answer the questions briefly.

1. What do you think is the story all about?
2. Which part of the story struck you the most? Why?

3. Where did the story happen?
4. What is the theme and point of view of the story?
5. What is the plot of the story?
6. How does the author use setting to enhance the mood of the story?

ACTIVITY 5. Outline it to Better Understand it. (20 minutes)

Utilizing the groupings from Activity 3, create a plot outline of the story. You may adapt or be guided by this format.



ACTIVITY 6. Emphasize. Answer this question.

1. How did the story “Powder” by Tobias Wolff affect your life as a teenager?

ACTIVITY 7. Lights! Camera! Action!

Today you are going to shoot your video/film adaptation of the short story “Powder” by Tobias Wolff.

You are given 5 minutes for preparation.

Please shoot your creative adaptation of “Bohemians” by George Saunders. You may roam around the campus to shoot. Choose suitable places for scenes and dialogues.

Please be careful and return after 25 minutes.

ACTIVITY 8. Video-editing

Please apply your concepts about film adaptation and transposition through video-editing.

Edit your video using applications for video editing or other multimedia applications. If time is not enough, you may continue your editing as a take-out work.

You are going to present your work the next day. Group 1 will present first, followed by Group 2 and so on and so forth. Thus, every video/ film adaptation will have a continuity.

ACTIVITY 9. Pre-Presentation Self-Assessment

Based on your own assessment, rate yourself using the criteria provided:

Criteria for Self-Assessment

Criteria	Rating	Your rating:
a. Interpretation/Characterization	30%	_____%
b. Creativity	30%	_____%
c. Sense of responsibility and cooperation	20%	_____%
d. Sense of oneness and concern for others	20%	_____%
TOTAL	100%	_____%

ACTIVITY 10. Mini-theatre – Video Presentation

Please enjoy the presentation of the video/ film adaptations by group.

Here is the order of the presentations:

Group 1

Group 2

Group 3

Group 4

You will be judged on the following:

Criteria	Rating
a. Style and organization	30%
b. Creativity	25%
c. Content	25%
d. Quality (sound, image, lighting)	20%
TOTAL	100%

Reflect on this quote by Bertrand Russel:

“The only thing that will redeem mankind is cooperation.”